Who Is There When Help Is Needed?

A coverage worksheet for your husband's next arrangement.

“I'll help” is kindness. “Tuesdays and Thursdays, nine to two” is coverage. This worksheet is for telling the two apart on paper.

Go through one ordinary day in six blocks. In each, write what your husband will need a hand with, as far as you've been told, and put a name only where someone has given you days and times. Where there is nobody, leave it blank. Where you don't know, write “don't know” and keep going.

The day, block by block

A block with only a general offer behind it counts as still open, and the offer itself goes in its own box further down. If weekends look different from weekdays, fill the page in twice.

PART OF THE DAY	WHAT HE'LL NEED A HAND WITH	WHO HAS SAID YES, AND WHICH DAYS	STILL OPEN
Early morning			
Morning			
Midday			
Afternoon			
Evening			
Overnight			

The help that's there now

Who is with him at the moment and what they do for him, including the staff where he is now. Only what you've seen or been told.

FOR EXAMPLE At night someone comes when he presses the call button. I don't know how often he presses it.

When he would be on his own

The stretches in the new arrangement when nobody else would be in the house, or when everyone would be asleep. Write the day and the hours, and leave it at that.

FOR EXAMPLE Thursdays, 1 to 3, while I'm at my own appointment. Most nights from about 11, once I'm asleep.

Offers without a day and a time yet

Everyone who has said they'll help but hasn't said when. Write what they said, the way they said it.

FOR EXAMPLE Our daughter: “I'll come whenever you need me.” She's two hours away. I haven't asked which days.

The hours that fall to you

Every block where the only name is yours. Then, honestly, which of them you can keep up and for how long. Your limits belong on this page as much as anyone's schedule does.

FOR EXAMPLE Every night, and every morning until our son gets here at 10. I can do the mornings. I don't know how long I can do the nights.

What you couldn't fill in

The blanks and the “don't know” entries from the grid, each written as a question, with who might be able to answer it.

FOR EXAMPLE Does someone need to be in the room with him at night, or just in the house? I don't know. Ask the nurse.

Filled in by, and on what date

What this shows you

Three things: when your husband will need someone, who has actually said yes, and which hours have nobody in them yet. It doesn't show whether the arrangement is safe or whether the help is enough, and no number of filled blocks adds up to a score. What an open hour means for him is for the people who assess him to say. Your part is making it visible.

Ready for the next step?

You've put the day on paper, with a name or a blank in each block. The care interview adds what the blocks can't show: what he can and can't do during those hours, who is caring for him, and what the care team has already said. It turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

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